Aldi: functional positioning through market-specific brand anchors

Private label clearly communicates functional benefits — but focuses on large, proven territories and familiar category formats.

Focused follower with simple, predictable execution: Aldi concentrates on a few big, proven territories, especially protein and organic / natural.

FRANCE

- **Milsani** — protein dairy anchor
- **Simplement Bon et Bio** — organic / natural

Protein is visible, broader positioning is dispersed.

UK

- **Brooklea** — protein dairy anchor
- **Harvest Morn** — protein + fibre / wholegrain

The clearest Aldi functional architecture: strong protein, supported by fibre / wholegrain.

US

- **Simply Nature** — broad better-for-you
- **Elevation** — specialist performance
- **Friendly Farms** — lower-fat / free-from

Broader mix: organic / natural, free-from, lower-fat and multi-benefit positioning.

Examples from analyzed packs

FR **Milsani**

Blueberry High Protein



PROTEIN

10.0 g protein / 100 g

UK **Harvest Morn**

Cookie Dough Bar



PROTEIN FIBRE

35.2 g protein, 11.6 g fiber / 100 g

US **Friendly Farms**

Lactose Free 2% Reduced Fat Milk



LACTOSE FREE REDUCED FAT

Mainstream dairy with multiple practical health cues

Lidl: functional positioning through reusable pan-European* brands

Lidl focuses on mainstream functional territories too — but scales them through a small set of repeatable brand roles.

Focused follower with simple, repeatable execution: protein is mature; fibre / wholegrain is the clearest secondary territory; Vemondo gives plant-based a dedicated home.

Milbona

PROTEIN DAIRY

FR ✓ UK/IE ✓

Crownfield

FIBRE / WHOLEGRAIN
+ protein cereals in UK

FR ✓ UK/IE ✓

Vemondo

PLANT-BASED / VEGAN

FR ✓ UK/IE ✓

Envia

PROTEIN / FRESH DAIRY

FR ✓ UK/IE —

The architecture is reusable rather than identical: the same core brands keep the same jobs, while markets add local extensions.

Examples from analyzed packs

FR **Milbona**

Crème dessert chocolat riche en protéine

PROTEIN

10.0 g protein / 100 g

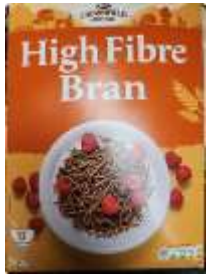


UK **Crownfield**

High Fibre Bran

FIBRE

23.8 g fibre / 100 g



UK **Vemondo**

Plant Grated Mature Cheddar

PLANT-BASED

Dedicated brand



*Pan-European architecture conclusion refers to France + UK/IE. US/Canada evidence is too thin to define a stable Lidl brand architecture.

Underlying nutrition: mostly close to the market

Visible functional positioning sits on a largely mainstream product base.

Aldi and Lidl mostly track the region-category market on underlying nutrition. Dairy protein is the consistent exception but it's mix-driven.

PROTEIN ≈ market — beverages • cereals • snacks; Dairy higher

SUGARS ≈ market — within region × category

FIBRE ≈ market — within region × category

Protein median, g / 100 g • Δ = retailer − market

Detailed table shown for protein; supporting benchmark reports sugars and fibre follow the same broad pattern.

REGION	CATEGORY	MARKET	ALDI	Δ	LIDL	Δ
France	Beverages	0.1	0.5	+0.4	0.2	+0.1
France	Cereals	9.3	8.9	-0.4	9.4	+0.1
France	Dairies	6.5	14.0	+7.5	11.0	+4.5
France	Snacks	6.4	6.3	-0.1	6.4	0.0
UK/IE	Beverages	0.1	0.4	+0.3	0.1	0.0
UK/IE	Cereals	10.0	9.2	-0.8	9.8	-0.2
UK/IE	Dairies	5.5	6.7	+1.2	7.5	+2.0
UK/IE	Snacks	6.2	6.3	+0.1	6.3	+0.1
US/Canada	Beverages	0.0	0.1	+0.1	0.3	+0.3
US/Canada	Cereals	9.1	8.5	-0.6	9.5	+0.4
US/Canada	Dairies	6.9	8.7	+1.7	8.0	+1.1
US/Canada	Snacks	6.9	7.1	+0.2	7.0	+0.1

Main exception: dairy protein density is higher for both discounters — especially France — driven mainly by assortment mix rather than simple reformulation.

OFF nutrition benchmark. Lidl US/Canada cells are directional because sample sizes are modest.

What do claim-bearing packs communicate?

Private-label functionality is visible — but the mix of benefits differs by market.

Among packs with at least one detected on-pack claim, % carrying each benefit territory. One pack can carry several benefits, so columns do not sum to 100%.

BENEFIT TERRITORY	FRANCE ALDI	FRANCE LIDL	UK/IE ALDI	UK/IE LIDL	US/CAN ALDI	US/CAN LIDL*
FUNCTIONAL — ADD / SUPPORT						
Protein	10%	**27%**	31%	33%	17%	**31%**
Fibre / wholegrain	12%	10%	14%	**23%**	18%	19%
Fortification	10%	13%	8%	6%	14%	12%
Energy	**10%**	0%	1%	2%	3%	0%
Gut health	1%	0%	1%	2%	4%	4%
Immune	0%	0%	3%	1%	2%	0%
FUNCTIONAL — REDUCE / REMOVE						
Sugar / fat reduction	12%	14%	**27%**	19%	19%	15%
Free-from (gluten / lactose / dairy)	6%	3%	5%	5%	**22%**	8%
QUALITY / VALUES / ORIGIN						
Organic / natural	**33%**	21%	12%	16%	**44%**	35%
Origin / provenance / quality	10%	**22%**	7%	9%	1%	**8%**
Clean label / no-additives	0%	3%	9%	5%	11%	15%
Plant-based / vegan	10%	6%	5%	9%	6%	4%
Sustainability	4%	3%	3%	2%	2%	0%

Bold = Aldi–Lidl gap ≥5 percentage points within the same market. *Lidl US/CAN: small sample (53). OCR/LLM-detected on-pack positioning; analyzed vision sample.

Aldi vs Lidl: focused followers, disciplined executors

Private label makes functional benefits mainstream by selecting proven needs and executing them simply, visibly and at scale.

WHAT THEY FOLLOW

Mainstream needs
Protein • Organic / Natural • Fibre or Free-from where relevant

HOW THEY EXECUTE

Visible claim • real delivery • familiar format
Then compete on taste, convenience and value

PORTFOLIO SYSTEM

ALDI
Market-specific anchors
FR Milsani • UK Brooklea / Harvest Morn • US Simply Nature / Elevation

LIDL
Reusable pan-European anchors
Milbona • Crownfield • Vemondo

WHAT THE PACK DATA SHOWS

CLAIM INCIDENCE

Aldi 36% | Lidl 43%

~4 in 10 analyzed packs communicate positioning

US / CANADA STACKING

~50% carry ≥2 tags

for both retailers among claim-bearing packs

MAINSTREAM CLAIMS

Protein • Organic • Free-from / Reduced
Fibre secondary

The advantage is not novelty. It is focused, simple and repeatable execution.